

Enterprise AI Credits Governance

A phase-led operating model for budgets, consumption, and control.



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Turn AI-credit settings into
**owned, tested, and
reversible** operating controls.

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AI-assisted delivery needs a control model.

The goal is not to slow adoption. It is to make every material change **owned, evidenced, tested, and reversible.**

01

VELOCITY

Teams need room to learn, ship, and use supported AI-assisted capabilities without unnecessary friction.

02

EXPOSURE

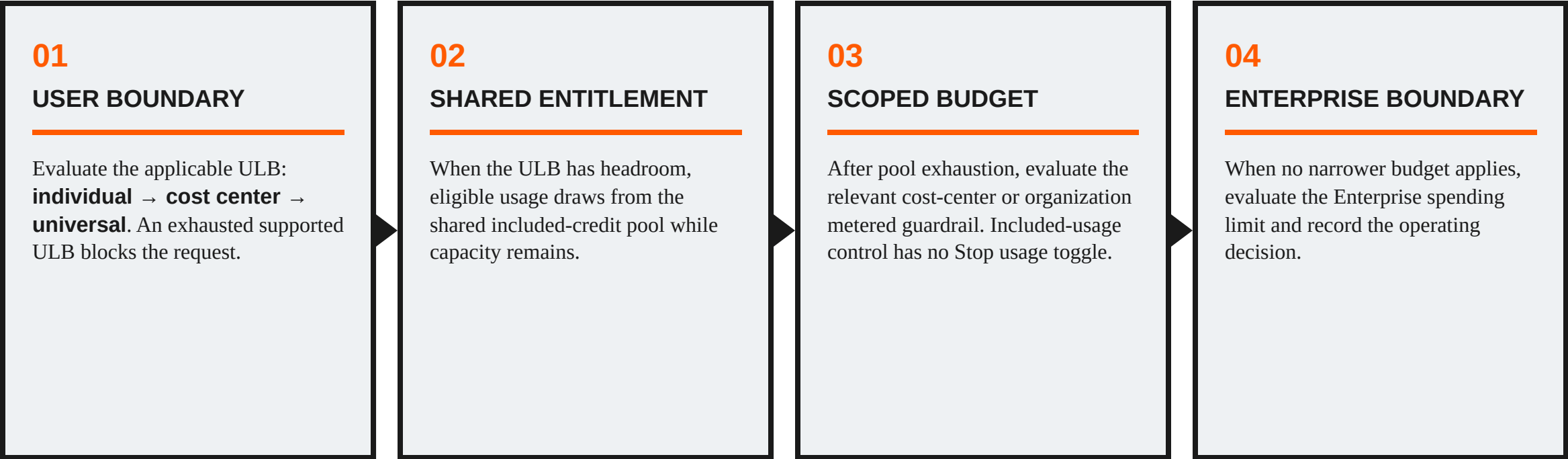
Consumption, entitlement, support, and operational consequences must be visible at the appropriate scope.

03

PROOF

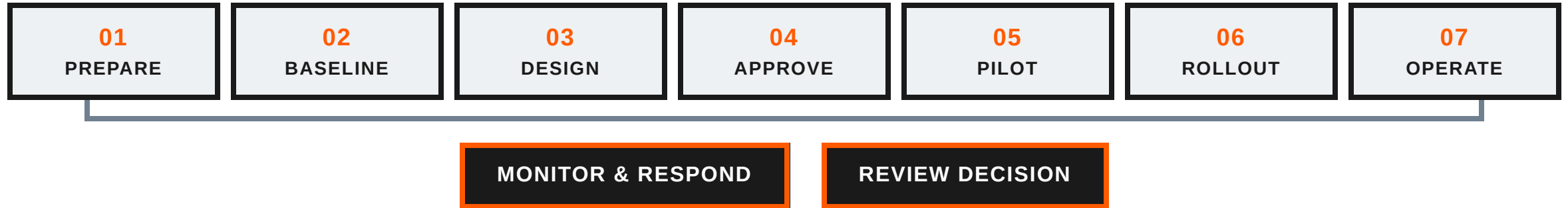
A dashboard setting is not enough. The organization needs evidence of effective behavior and a tested rollback path.

Use the decision path before changing controls.



OPERATING RULE	Do not infer effective enforcement from a dashboard or screenshot. Capture provider evidence, validate the selected scope, and test the actual outcome.
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Seven phases turn settings into governed operations



Prepare → Baseline → Design → Approve → Pilot → Rollout → Operate
create an evidence-led sequence for every material control change.

Each phase has an explicit exit condition, owner, evidence requirement, and next decision.

Monitor & Respond and **Review Decision** are continuous loop components, not additional linear phases.

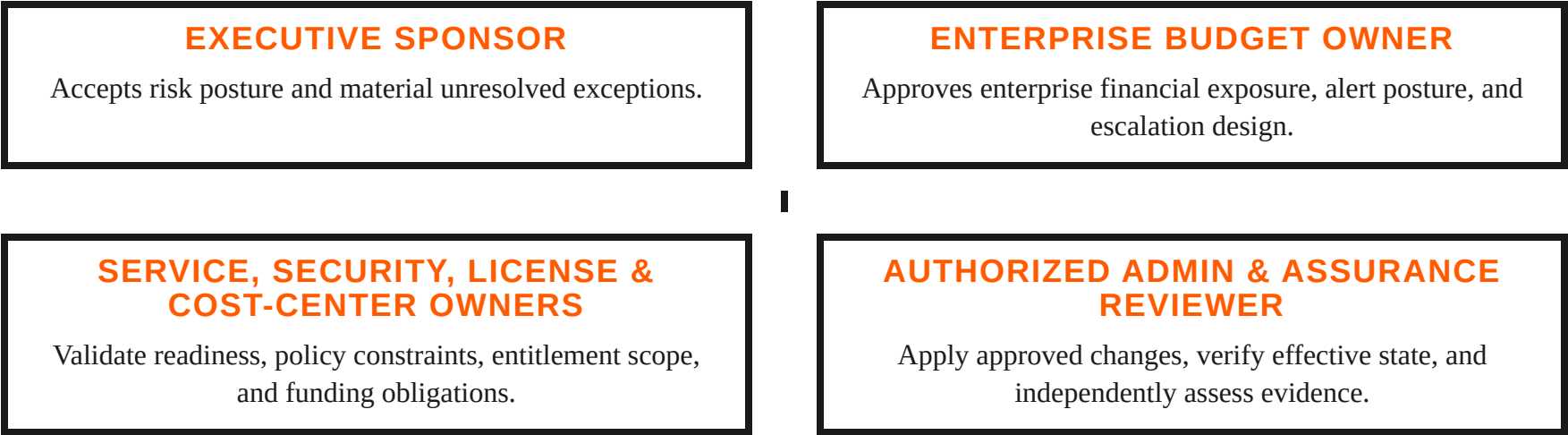
Use the operating model to sequence evidence, configuration, validation, and accountable decisions.

Five layers must stay distinct.

[1] [2] [5]

User-Level Budget	PER USER AI CREDITS	Applicable ULB is a hard stop; precedence is individual → cost center → universal.
Shared included-credit pool	BILLING ENTITY AI CREDITS	Shared entitlement, not a per-user assignment budget.
Cost-center included-usage	COST CENTER AI CREDITS	Provider-calculated pre-metered control; it does not own Stop usage.
Scoped metered budget	COST CENTER / ORG USD	Post-pool paid-usage guardrail; Stop usage requires support and evidence.
Enterprise spending limit	ENTERPRISE USD	Final enterprise-wide paid-usage boundary, not a ULB or total bill.

Governance starts with accountable ownership.



IMPLEMENTATION RULE	Name people, delegates, support routes, and rollback decision owners—not just role titles.
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Prepare and baseline before proposing target state.

01

INVENTORY CURRENT STATE

Document current policies, ULBs, budgets, assignments, cost centers, license scope, and available evidence.

02

VERIFY EFFECTIVE BEHAVIOR

Distinguish **configured state** from **effective behavior**; do not assume equal settings behave the same across scope.

03

ESTABLISH THE REGISTER

Create the Active Register as the controlled system of record, with history, protected key fields, mandatory evidence, and phase-exit snapshots.

BASELINE OUTCOME

Current state, unknowns, variances, evidence freshness, and material exceptions are visible before design begins.

Design controls around scope, unit, and enforcement.

[1] [2]

01 USER-LEVEL BUDGETS

Design ULB cohorts and naming rules first. Verify **cost-center membership** before assigning production users to ensure accurate precedence.

02 SHARED ENTITLEMENT

Record shared-entitlement baselines separately from enforceable paid-usage guardrails. They are **forecast and reconciliation** records, not hard stops.

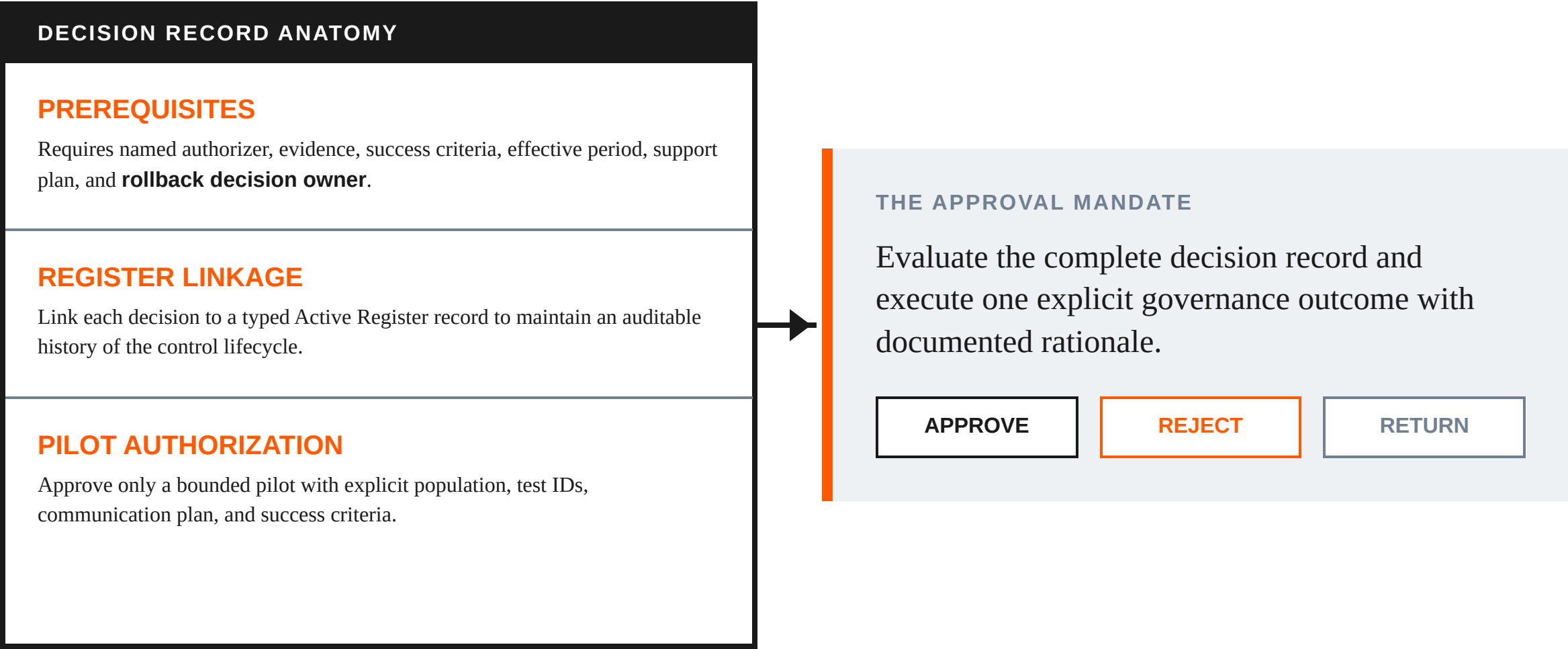
03 METERED BUDGETS

Define USD amount, covered SKUs, provider-supported alert thresholds, recipients, response SLA, **Stop usage intent**, and rollback evidence.

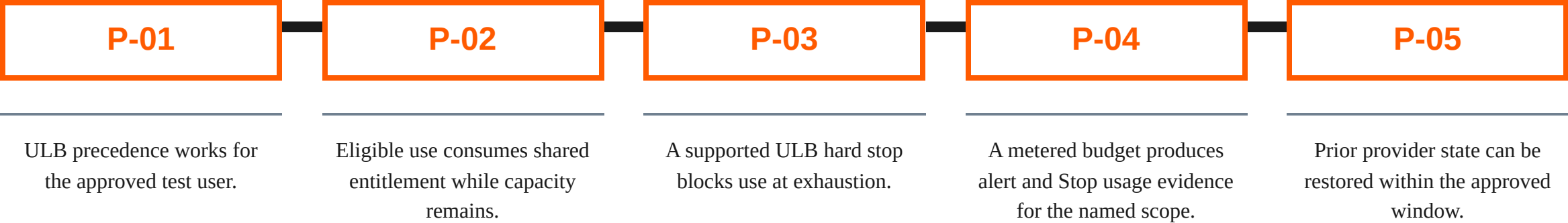
EVIDENCE GATE

Observed UI values are examples, not universal defaults. Record current provider behavior and configuration evidence for the selected scope.

Approval makes accountability operational.



Pilot the behavior—not just the configuration.



PILOT APPROACH	Pilot in a limited, non-critical window with representative users and evidence of configured and effective state.
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Roll out in waves; operate through evidence.

06 ROLLOUT

CONTROLLED WAVES

Apply only approved and piloted controls in controlled waves; each wave is an Active Register record.

PAUSE CONDITIONS

Pause the next wave when configured state, effective behavior, scope, owner, or rollback evidence differs from the approved record.



07 OPERATE

WEEKLY TRIAGE

Sustain the model with weekly signal triage, variance analysis, training, and evidence-led adjustment.

MONTHLY RECONCILIATION

Reconcile provider state, active alerts, and assignments to ensure the control environment remains accurate and funded.

OPERATING EXIT CONDITION

Register, provider state, owners, signals, and review schedule remain current.

The Active Register is the implementation backbone.

LOGICAL KEY

Base key: (**record_type**, **scope_id**, **enterprise_control_id**); append profile/version only when a named control pattern applies.

CANONICAL SCHEMA

Capture canonical fields for scope, unit, owner, evidence, approval, testing, response, exception, and rollback.

PROVIDER-NEUTRAL ALERTS

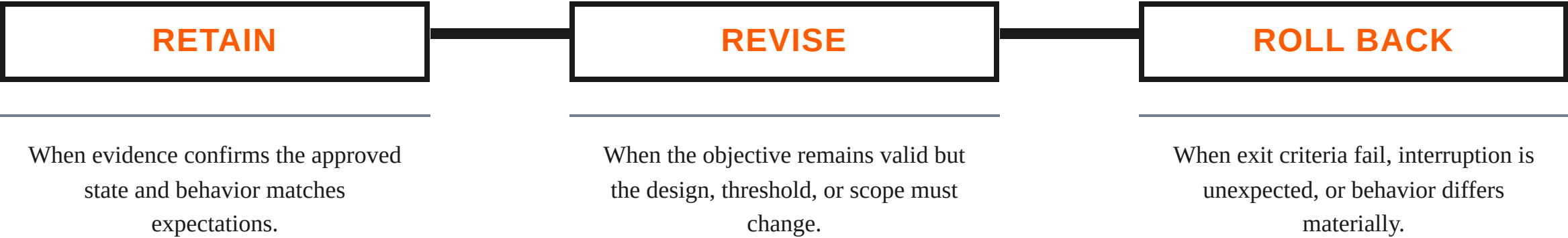
Use **alert_thresholds** as an ordered provider-supported list; preserve observed values (e.g., 75%; 90%; 100%) as evidence, not fixed defaults.

EVIDENCE & SKUS

Store covered SKUs as a semicolon-separated list; use a provider ID only when exposed, otherwise preserve configuration URL and retrieval timestamp.

Monitor signals and make explicit decisions.

Validate every alert against the named control base, unit, scope, source freshness, forecast, owner, and user impact. Update the Active Register only after provider state and evidence agree.



THE TRUE PURPOSE	Monitoring is not reporting: it is the decision loop that keeps controls safe, useful, and current.
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Start with a bounded, evidence-led implementation.

01

Establish ownership, source list, evidence plan, and Active Register location.

02

Reconcile the entitlement baseline and current control state.

03

Design distinct ULB, included-usage, metered-budget, and enterprise-limit records.

04

Approve a bounded pilot; capture P-01 through P-05 evidence.

05

Roll out in controlled waves, then operate through weekly triage and monthly reconciliation.

PRIMARY SOURCE BASIS

GitHub Docs on usage-based billing, budgets, budget controls, optimization, and cost centers.
[\[1\]](#) [\[2\]](#) [\[3\]](#) [\[4\]](#) [\[5\]](#)

Source basis and responsible use.

[1] GitHub Docs

Usage-based billing for organizations and enterprises

[2] GitHub Docs

Budgets for usage-based billing

[3] GitHub Docs

Getting started with budget controls

[4] GitHub Docs

Optimizing your budget configuration

[5] GitHub Docs

Cost centers



PRODUCTION CAVEAT

Provider capabilities, UI labels, pricing, roles, and enforcement behavior can change.

Confirm current documentation and tenant evidence before applying production controls.